PUPIL NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

YEAR 7 ENQUIRY • 1066–1485

Medieval England: 1066–1485

Conquest, Castles, Church & The Shattering of Feudalism



PRIMARY VISUAL EVIDENCE • ANGLO-NORMAN EMBROIDERY — The Bayeux Tapestry (c. 1070s)

Commissioned by Bishop Odo of Bayeux within a decade of 1066, this 70-metre embroidered linen masterpiece records the Norman Conquest as both triumphant statecraft and a profound human catastrophe:

1. THE SAXON SHIELD WALL AT SENLAC:
Interlocking wooden round shields and Danish two-handed battleaxes held the ridge against hours of Norman cavalry charges and arrow storms.

2. NORMAN HEAVY CAVALRY WITH COUCHED LANCES:
Iron stirrups and high pommel saddles allowed Norman knights to deliver devastating shock charges, transforming European medieval battle tactics.

3. DUKE WILLIAM UNMASKS HIS HELMET:
When panic spread that Duke William was dead, he pushed back his nasal-helmet shouting: *'Look at me! I live and by God's grace shall conquer!'*

4. THE SLAIN KING & THE MARGINAL DEAD:
King Harold is struck down beside his golden dragon standard; the bottom frieze shows stripped armor, severed limbs, and dead warriors.

COUCHED LANCE	PAPAL BANNER	MARGINAL FRIEZE
Shock cavalry breaking infantry shield walls.	Holy crusade moral blessing from Rome.	Brutal human carnage of Norman conquest.

DISCIPLINARY SIGNIFICANCE: Embroidered by English seamstresses under Norman rule, the tapestry serves both as Norman triumphal propaganda and a poignant Anglo-Saxon testimony to national defeat.

DISCIPLINARY HINGE QUESTION: HISTORICAL EVALUATION

Does the Bayeux Tapestry celebrate William's conquest as the righteous will of God, or does its vivid marginal art subtly subvert Norman triumph by mourning the destruction of Saxon England?

Primary Visual Evidence: *Battle of Hastings Detail • The Death of King Harold* • Bayeux Tapestry Museum (c. 1070–1077)

BAYEUX ARCHIVE • UNESCO MEMORY OF THE WORLD

COURSE SPECIFICATION • KEY ENQUIRY SEQUENCE	LEARNT	REVISED
Enquiry 1: 1066 & The Battle of Hastings *Why did William of Normandy win the Battle of Hastings in 1066, and how did Senlac Hill decide England's fate?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 2: Castles, Terror & Domesday *How did 10,000 Normans subjugate 2 million Saxons through castles, the Harrying of the North, and the Domesday audit?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 3: Crown vs Church: Henry II & Thomas Becket *Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket over canon law, and why did Becket's murder force royal penance?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 4: Magna Carta (1215) & Medieval Kingship *Was Magna Carta a selfish barons' tax revolt or a revolutionary foundation of due process and the Rule of Law?*	☐	☐
Enquiry 5: The Black Death (1348) & The Peasants' Revolt (1381) *How did bubonic plague wipe out half of England's population and inspire Wat Tyler's rebellion to shatter serfdom?*	☐	☐

Why did William of Normandy win the Battle of Hastings in 1066?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 Jan 1066 • Why did the death of Edward the Confessor trigger a succession crisis?

- Childless English King
- Three Rival Claimants
- Witan Backs Harold

2 1066 • Who were the three rival claimants contending for the English crown?

- English Earl Takes Crown
- Fierce Viking Giant
- Duke Promised the Throne

3 Sept 1066 • How did the Battle of Stamford Bridge exhaust King Harold's northern forces?

- 300 Viking Longships
- Fierce River Clash
- Marching Night and Day

4 14 Oct 1066 • How did the Anglo-Saxon shield wall withstand repeated Norman charges on Senlac Hill?

- Steep Slippery Ridge
- Locked Wooden Shields
- Two-Handed Battleaxes

5 Oct 1066 • How did the feigned retreat tactic break the shield wall and secure Norman victory?

- Pretending to Run Away
- Chasing Down the Hill
- Arrow Strikes Harold

King Harold marched his army 200 miles north to beat the Vikings, then 200 miles back south in 14 days before fighting Hastings.

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

Explain why William of Normandy achieved victory at the Battle of Hastings in 1066. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **Norman military tactics, heavy cavalry, and the feigned retreat** | **Anglo-Saxon exhaustion and loss of shield-wall discipline** *(Support each factor with your own precise historical evidence)*

1. MILITARY TACTICS	2. SAXON EXHAUSTION	3. COMPARATIVE VERDICT
Analyse Norman combined-arms coordination, heavy shock cavalry charges, archer volleys, and the feigned retreat on Senlac Hill.	Analyse the impact of King Harold's 200-mile forced march following Stamford Bridge and the loss of shield-wall discipline.	Weigh whether Norman tactical superiority or Anglo-Saxon physical exhaustion and tactical errors proved more decisive.

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

A primary factor was... • In particular, this caused... • Furthermore, this was significant because... • As a direct result... • Consequently, this led to...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Senlac Hill • shield wall • feigned retreat • heavy cavalry • housecarls • Harold Godwinson • Stamford Bridge • Duke William • Norman archers

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Turn to **Page 8** and use the app's *Consolidate Station* to branch out the **1066 Battle of Hastings & Conquest** node (Stamford Bridge exhaustion, Senlac shield wall, Norman feigned retreat).

How did the Normans subjugate England and enforce total royal control?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1066–1068 • How did the motte-and-bailey blitz allow 10,000 Normans to dominate 2 million Saxons?

- High Earth Mounds
- Quick Timber Walls
- 500 Castles Built Fast

2 1069–1070 • Why did William unleash the brutal scorched-earth Harrying of the North?

- Rebels Attack York
- Burning Every Crop
- 100,000 Starve to Death

3 1070–1100 • How did massive stone keeps like Portchester Castle project permanent imperial permanence?

- Ancient Roman Walls
- Thick Limestone Keep
- Deep Warship Harbour

4 1085–1086 • Why did William commission the exhaustive Domesday Book audit at Gloucester?

- Fearing Viking Invasion
- Counting Every Cow and Pig
- Paying Every Penny in Tax

5 1086 • What does the local Domesday hundred reveal about Anglo-Saxon land dispossession?

- Hundred of Fareham Survey
- English Landlords Kicked Out
- Barons Take the Manors

Anglo-Saxons called it the "Domesday Book" because you could no more appeal William's tax survey than escape the Last Judgement.

Question 1: Describe Two Features [4 marks • 5 mins]

FEATURE DRILL

Describe two features of Norman motte-and-bailey castles. [4 marks]

Sentence Stems: Feature 1: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this involved... • Feature 2: A second key feature was... • Detail: This served the purpose of...

Question 2: Explain One Consequence [4 marks • 5 mins]

STRUCTURED WRITING

Explain one consequence of the motte-and-bailey blitz for Anglo-Saxon resistance against Norman rule. [4 marks]

Focus on how fortified castles allowed small Norman garrisons to dominate thousands of hostile Saxons and suppress regional revolts.

Analytical Connectives: *A significant consequence was that... • In particular, this meant that... • Furthermore, this led to... • Consequently, the impact was...*

Key Terms: motte-and-bailey • garrison • timber palisade • intimidation • Harrying of the North • Portchester Castle • Domesday Book

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your structured response below:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Turn to **Page 8** and use the app's *Consolidate Station* to branch out the **1069–70 Harrying & Motte Blitz** and **1086 Domesday Survey** nodes (500 castles, Yorkshire famine, Portchester keep).

Portchester Castle's Norman keep was built inside 1,700-year-old Roman fortress walls that guarded the Solent sea approaches.

Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket, and who triumphed?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1154–1162 • Why did Henry II appoint his worldly drinking companion Becket as Archbishop?

- King's Hunting Friend
- Silk Robes and Feasting
- Hoping for an Easy Puppet

2 1162 • How did Becket's sudden spiritual transformation shock King Henry?

- Throws Off Silk Robes
- Scratchy Goat Hairshirt
- Loyal Only to the Pope

3 1164 • Why did the Constitutions of Clarendon and 'criminous clerks' provoke an open rift?

- Priests Escaping Punishment
- Reading a Latin Verse
- King Demands Royal Trials

4 29 Dec 1170 • How did royal rage culminate in brutal murder in Canterbury Cathedral?

- King Shouts in Fury
- Four Knights Gallop Away
- Swords Smashed at the Altar

5 1170–1174 • Why was Henry II forced to perform barefoot public penance at Canterbury?

- Miracles at the Tomb
- Whipping with Birch Rods
- Church Courts Kept Intact

Henry II was so furious with Becket that he reportedly shouted: 'Will no one rid me of this turbulent priest?' Four knights took him literally.

Question 3(b) & 3(c): Contrasting Interpretations [8 marks • 10 mins]

HISTORIOGRAPHICAL ANALYSIS

INTERPRETATION 1 • EDWARD GRIM, EYEWITNESS MONK & CHRONICLER, LIFE OF ST THOMAS (C. 1175)

"The glorious martyr Thomas stood like a rock before the altar, refusing to yield the sacred liberties of Christ's holy Church to earthly tyrants. He offered his neck to the wicked swords of the four knights, dying willingly so that God's law might triumph over royal pride."

INTERPRETATION 2 • HISTORIAN FRANK BARLOW, THOMAS BECKET (1986)

"Becket was vain, stubborn, and obsessively confrontational. Having served Henry faithfully as chancellor, his dramatic conversion into an unbending champion of clerical privilege was theatrical extremism. By shielding rapists and murderers in holy orders from secular law, Becket provoked a needless crisis."

Explain how Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on Thomas Becket's motives and character. [4 marks]

PART B

Sentence Stems: Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on… • Interpretation 1 argues that… • In contrast, Interpretation 2 suggests that… • This is a difference because…

Task: *Write your comparison of Interpretations 1 and 2 below:*

Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ on Becket's clash with King Henry II. [4 marks]

PART C

Scaffolded Sentence Stems: One reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ is because they have a different focus… • Specifically, Interpretation 1 focuses primarily on… • In contrast, Interpretation 2 focuses more on… • As a result, the authors reach different conclusions because…

Task: *Explain why the interpretations differ by analysing their different points of focus:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Turn to **Page 8** and use the app's *Consolidate Station* to branch out the **1170 Murder of Becket at Canterbury** node (Constitutions of Clarendon, criminous clerks, Henry II's barefoot penance).

Norman Conquest, Castles, Domesday & The Church

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Causes & Context to the left • Events & Control to the right).

◂ STAMFORD BRIDGE & SHIELD WALL

1066 Battle of Hastings & Conquest (Enq 1)

FEIGNED RETREAT & CROWN ▸

◂ 10,000 NORMANS & YORK REVOLT

1069–70 Harrying of North & Motte Blitz (Enq 2)

SALTED FIELDS & 500 CASTLES ▸

◂ VIKING THREAT & TAX AUDIT

1086 Domesday Survey & Stone Keeps (Enq 2)

PORTCHESTER KEEP & BARONS ▸

◂ CLARENDON & CRIMINOUS CLERKS

1170 Murder of Becket at Canterbury (Enq 3)

ALTAR MURDER & PENANCE ▸

CURRICULUM SPINE CONTINUES TO MAGNA CARTA, PLAGUE & REVOLT (PAGE 9) ➔

Magna Carta, Parliament, Black Death & Peasants' Revolt

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Crisis & Pressures to the left • Law, Rights & Legacy to the right).

◂ NORMANDY LOSS & BOUVINES

1215 Sealing of Magna Carta (Enq 4)

RUNNYMEDE & CLAUSE 39 LAW ▸

◂ BARONIAL REVOLT VS CROWN

1265 Simon de Montfort's Parliament (Enq 4)

SHIRE KNIGHTS & BURGESSES ▸

◂ DORSET PLAGUE & MORTALITY

1348–49 Black Death & Labour Shortage (Enq 5)

WAGE RISE & 1351 STATUTE ▸

◂ REGRESSIVE POLL TAXES

1381 Peasants' Revolt at Smithfield (Enq 5)

WAT TYLER & END OF SERFDOM ▸

MEDIEVAL ENGLAND CURRICULUM SPINE COMPLETE (1066–1381) ➔

Was Magna Carta a foundation of human liberty or a selfish barons' power grab?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1199–1204 • Why did the loss of Normandy earn King John the mocking nickname 'Softsword'?

- Losing French Castles
- Barons Laugh at Softsword
- Desperate for Silver

2 1205–1213 • How did scutage tax extortion and the papal interdict alienate the realm?

- Shield Money Demands
- Locked Church Doors
- Dead Buried in Ditches

3 1214 • How did the catastrophic defeat at the Battle of Bouvines shatter John's authority?

- Huge War Chest Emptied
- Allies Smashed in France
- Barons Refuse More Taxes

4 15 June 1215 • What revolutionary legal principle was enshrined in Clause 39 at Runnymede?

- Barons Draw Their Swords
- No Jail Without Fair Trial
- King Bound by the Law

5 1215–1216 • Why did the First Barons' War erupt immediately after the charter was sealed?

- Pope Tears Up the Treaty
- French Prince Invited In
- Crown Jewels Lost in the Wash

King John did not sign Magna Carta with a pen; he affixed his royal wax seal because medieval kings rarely signed documents.

Question 2: Narrative Account [8 marks • 12 mins]

NARRATIVE ACCOUNT

Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading from the loss of Normandy (1204) to the sealing of Magna Carta (1215). [8 marks]

Stimulus: **The loss of Normandy and heavy scutage taxation** | **The defeat at the Battle of Bouvines (1214)**

(Support each factor with your own precise historical evidence)

CHRONOLOGICAL CONNECTIVES:

Initially, the sequence began when... • Following this, the next development was... • A turning point occurred when... • Consequently... • This ultimately resulted in...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Normandy • scutage • Pope Innocent III • Battle of Bouvines (1214) • Runnymede • Clause 39 • Magna Carta • Robert Fitzwalter

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your continuous narrative account below:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Turn to **Page 9** and use the app's *Consolidate Station* to branch out the **1215 Sealing of Magna Carta** and **1265 de Montfort's Parliament** nodes (Bouvines defeat, Clause 39 rule of law, elected Commons).

Magna Carta originally applied only to "free men"—which in 1215 meant wealthy barons and churchmen, excluding 80% of peasants who were serfs.

How did demographic catastrophe and peasant rebellion shatter the feudal order?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1348–1349 • How did the Black Death wipe out nearly half the population of England?

- Sailor Ship at Weymouth
- Buboes Under the Arms
- Nearly Half the Country Dead

2 1349–1351 • Why did demographic collapse trigger an unprecedented economic power shift?

- Empty Village Cottages
- Wheat Rotting on the Ground
- Workers Demanding Double Pay

3 1351–1377 • How did the Statute of Labourers and sumptuary laws provoke bitter class resentment?

- Wages Frozen by Lords
- Iron "F" Burned on Foreheads
- Banned from Wearing Fur

4 1377–1381 • Why did the regressive Poll Taxes of 1377–1381 spark armed peasant uprising?

- French War Debt Bill
- Twelve Pence from Every Head
- Tax Collector Chased with Pitchforks

5 June 1381 • How did the showdown at Smithfield shatter the myth of unquestioned feudal authority?

- Peasants Swarm the Capital
- Tyler Stabbed at the Peace Talks
- Boy King Promises Freedom

Preacher John Ball asked: 'When Adam delved and Eve span, who was then the gentleman?'—arguing God never created masters and serfs.

Question 5: Evaluative Statement Essay [12 marks • 15 mins]

EXTENDED WRITING PRACTICE

'The Black Death of 1348 was the main cause of the breakdown of the feudal system in medieval England.' How far do you agree? [12 marks]

Stimulus: **The demographic collapse and labour shortage caused by the Black Death (1348–1350)** | **The 1351 Statute of Labourers and the Peasants' Revolt of 1381**

(Support each factor with your own precise historical evidence)

1. PLAGUE & ECONOMIC LEVERAGE	2. REPRESSION & SOCIAL REBELLION	3. COMPARATIVE VERDICT
Explain how the death of up to 50% of the population created a desperate shortage of agricultural labour, forcing lords to pay wages.	Explain how parliamentary laws (Statute of Labourers) and poll taxes failed to stop peasant mobility, culminating in the 1381 Revolt.	Weigh whether biological demographic collapse or political peasant resistance ultimately dealt the fatal blow to feudal serfdom.

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

To a large extent, it can be argued that... • On the one hand, a key factor was... • Furthermore, this was significant because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • In conclusion, the decisive reason why... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Black Death (1348) • Yersinia pestis • labour shortage • Statute of Labourers (1351) • sumptuary laws • Poll Tax • Wat Tyler • John Ball • serfdom / villeinage

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 8–9

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 8–9 →

Turn to **Page 9** and use the app's *Consolidate Station* to branch out the **1348–49 Black Death** and **1381 Peasants' Revolt** nodes (labour shortage, 1351 Statute of Labourers, Poll Tax & Smithfield).

NOTES

Notes: Record key causal links, essay plans, and teacher feedback for this unit.

NOTES

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY • PUPIL PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT RECORD

PUPIL NAME: _____ **CLASS:** _____ **TARGET KS3 LEVEL:** _____

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORY ASSESSMENT PATHWAYS • LEVEL DESCRIPTORS & CRITERIA

YEARS 7–9 STANDARDS

EMERGING (1–2)	EMERGING+ (3)	EXPECTED (4–5)	EXPECTED+ (6–7)	GREATER DEPTH (8–9)
Identifies key names, dates, and terms; describes what happened using simple statements and structured writing frames.	Describes reasons why events occurred; begins to explain causes and consequences supported by basic historical facts.	Constructs structured paragraphs explaining multiple causes and consequences; substantiates arguments with precise historical dates, key terms, and named figures.	Weighs competing factors and perspectives; explains why certain causes were more decisive than others using detailed, accurate evidence across the unit.	Crafts sustained, analytically rigorous arguments reaching a substantiated historical judgement; masterfully synthesizes evidence across the unit to evaluate complex turning points and long-term significance.

DATE	ENQUIRY • ASSESSMENT FOCUS	DO NOW (/5)	KS3 LEVEL / EFFORT	TEACHER COMMENT / SPELLINGS
	Enquiry 1: 1066 & Battle of Hastings Causal Analysis: Why did William win at Hastings?	/ 5		
	Enquiry 2: Castles, Terror & Domesday Feature Drill & Motte-and-Bailey Blitz	/ 5		
	Enquiry 3: Crown vs Church: Henry II & Becket Contrasting Interpretations: Character of Becket	/ 5		
	Enquiry 4: Magna Carta & Medieval Kingship Narrative Account & Importance of Clause 39	/ 5		
	Enquiry 5: Black Death & The Peasants' Revolt Evaluative Essay: Causes of Feudal Breakdown	/ 5		
	Independent Study & Notes Portfolio Pages 14–15 Enquiry Notes, Reflection & Revision Tasks	—		
	Teacher-Designated Assessment Task	—		

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

ONLINE RECALL

ENQUIRY 1	ENQUIRY 2	ENQUIRY 3	ENQUIRY 4	ENQUIRY 5
Hastings 1066	Castles & Terror	Crown vs Church	Magna Carta	Black Death
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]	Best Score: [/ 8]

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